

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

2000-03-12

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

1 dear b ahá'í f riends,
2 in a letter addressed to you under the date of 30 may 1997, the univer-
3 sal house of justice announced its decision to establish regional bahá'í
4 councils as a new element of bahá'í administration, between the local and
5 national levels.³²⁶⁻¹ These institutions are formed only with the permission
6 of the house of justice in certain countries where the growing complexity
7 of the issues which are facing National Spiritual Assemblies requires this
8 development. As specified by the house of justice case by case for the coun-
9 tries directly concerned, a regional council is established either through
10 election by the members of the local Spiritual Assemblies in a region or
11 through appointment by the National Spiritual Assembly, which receives
12 recommendations of candidates from local Spiritual Assemblies in the
13 region. The date set for formation of regional councils has been 23 may,
14 the anniversary of the declaration of the báb according to the gregorian
15 calendar.
16 To keep you informed of essential aspects of the evolution of regional
17 councils, we have been asked to convey the following.
18 in view of the experience gained over a period of several years, the house
19 of justice has recognized that it would be more practical to set a new date
20 for the formation of these institutions. henceforth, then, the election or ap-
21 pointment of regional councils will take effect every year on 26 November,
22 the day of the covenant. The formation processes will, of course, have to
23 be set in motion in sufficient time to be concluded on this date.
24 with loving b ahá'í greetings,

for Department of tHe secretariat

23 326-1. See no. 250, pp. 582–93.326.1

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327 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

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Election of New Member

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]